

POTS — MVP Specification

Stay Rooted

Vision

POTS is a next-generation social platform for Gen Z communities centered around authentic conversations, niche interests, internet culture, plants, books, technology, and real-world discussions.

The platform combines:

- calm aesthetics
- expressive freedom
- community-driven discovery
- identity-based interaction
- interest-focused social networking

POTS aims to become a calmer, more thoughtful alternative to overstimulating mainstream social media.

Core MVP Goal

The MVP should validate:

1. Will Gen Z users actively post and engage?
2. Can niche communities organically form?
3. Does the “digital garden” identity resonate?
4. Can aesthetic + authentic social interaction coexist?
5. Do users return daily?

The MVP should prioritize:

- interaction
- retention
- identity
- content creation
- discovery

NOT complexity.

Target Audience

Primary Users

1. Plant Enthusiasts

- indoor gardeners
- urban jungle creators
- propagation hobbyists

2. Gen Z Users

- internet-native audiences
- aesthetic-focused users
- culture-driven communities

3. Tech Enthusiasts

- developers
- AI enthusiasts
- startup culture
- future-tech discussions

4. Book Lovers

- dark academia communities
- philosophy readers
- fiction and non-fiction reviewers

5. Authentic/Unfiltered Content Consumers

- users tired of algorithm-heavy platforms
- people seeking real conversations
- internet culture communities

Brand Identity

Theme

A “digital garden” where ideas grow organically.

Tone

- calm

- reflective
- authentic
- aesthetic
- intelligent
- community-driven

Core Metaphors

Social Concept	POTS Equivalent
Post	Pot
Trending Topics	Trending Roots
Community Growth	Grow Together
Feed	Garden
Create Post	Plant a Thought

MVP Features

1. Authentication

Required

- Sign up
- Login
- Logout
- Forgot password

Optional Later

- OAuth
- magic links
- MFA

2. User Profiles

Features

- profile picture
- cover image

- bio
- username
- interests/tags
- followers/following
- posts count

Tabs

- Pots
 - Replies
 - Media
-

3. Create Pot (Post System)

Post Types

- text
- image
- text + image

Features

- character limit
- hashtags/roots
- timestamps
- image uploads

Future Expansion

- polls
 - long-form essays
 - threads
 - videos
-

4. Feed System

Home Feed

Mixed discovery + following content.

Following Feed

Only followed users.

Trending Feed

Popular discussions and roots.

5. Interactions

MVP Actions

- like
 - reply
 - repost
 - save/bookmark
 - share
-

6. Explore Page

Features

- trending roots
 - search users
 - search topics
 - discover creators
 - featured communities
-

7. Notifications

MVP Notifications

- likes
 - follows
 - replies
 - reposts
-

8. Search

Search Types

- users
 - roots/tags
 - posts
-

9. Moderation

MVP Moderation

- report post
- block user
- mute user

Minimal moderation initially but enough to prevent platform abuse.

Suggested Tech Stack

Frontend

Recommended

- Next.js
- Tailwind CSS
- TypeScript

Why

- scalable
 - fast iteration
 - modern ecosystem
 - SEO-ready
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Backend

Recommended

- Supabase OR Firebase for MVP

Supabase Preferred Because

- PostgreSQL
 - realtime support
 - authentication
 - storage
 - row-level security
 - scalable later
-

Database Models

User

- id
- username
- bio
- avatar
- cover_image
- created_at

Pot

- id
- user_id
- content
- image_url
- created_at

Like

- user_id
- pot_id

Follow

- follower_id
- following_id

Comment

- id
 - user_id
 - pot_id
 - content
-

MVP Pages

Required Pages

1. Landing Page

- brand identity
- onboarding
- sign up/login

2. Home Feed

3. Explore

4. Profile

5. Notifications

6. Create Pot Modal/Page

Design Principles

UI Goals

- soft visual hierarchy
- earthy colors
- low visual noise
- comfortable reading
- immersive content

Avoid

- excessive dopamine mechanics
 - aggressive animations
 - cluttered interfaces
 - overstimulation
-

MVP Success Metrics

Key Metrics

Retention

- daily active users
- weekly retention

Engagement

- posts per user
- comments per post
- session duration

Community

- follows
 - conversations
 - trending roots usage
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What NOT To Build Initially

Avoid:

- live streaming
- NFTs
- marketplaces
- complicated AI systems
- stories
- short-form video feed
- massive recommendation engines

The goal is:

- community first

- culture first
 - identity first
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Long-Term Vision

POTS evolves into:

- a calmer social internet
- an identity-based platform
- a niche-community ecosystem
- a modern digital culture hub

Positioning: “A digital garden for authentic internet culture.”

Suggested MVP Timeline

Phase 1 — Core Social

2–4 weeks

- auth
- posting
- feeds
- profiles

Phase 2 — Community

2–3 weeks

- explore
- notifications
- trending roots

Phase 3 — Polish

2 weeks

- performance
 - animations
 - responsive design
 - onboarding
-

Final MVP Philosophy

The MVP should feel:

- intimate
- aesthetic
- authentic
- calm
- culturally aware

Users should immediately understand: "This is not another loud social media platform."